Iteration D3: Adding a Button

Now that that's done, it's time to add an Add to Cart button for each product.

We don't need to create a new controller or even a new action. Taking a look at the actions provided by the scaffold generator, we find `index`, `show`, `new`, `edit`, `create`, `update`, and `destroy`. The one that matches this operation is `create`. (`new` may sound similar, but its use is to get a form that's used to solicit input for a subsequent `create` action.)

Once this decision is made, the rest follows. What are we creating? Certainly not a `Cart` or even a `Product`. What we're creating is a `LineItem`. Looking at the comment associated with the `create` method in `app/controllers/line_items_controller.rb`, you see that this choice also determines the URL to use (`/line_items`) and the HTTP method (`POST`).

This choice even suggests the proper UI control to use. When we added links before, we used `link_to`, but links default to using HTTP `GET`. We want to use `POST`, so we'll add a button this time; this means we'll be using the `button_to` method.

We could connect the button to the line item by specifying the URL, but again we can let Rails take care of this for us by simply appending `_path` to the controller's name. In this case, we'll use `line_items_path`.

However, there's a problem with this: how will the `line_items_path` method know *which* product to add to our cart? We'll need to pass it the ID of the product corresponding to the button. All we need to do is add the `:product_id` option to the `line_items_path` call. We can even pass in the `product` instance itself—Rails knows to extract the ID from the record in circumstances such as these.

In all, the *one* line that we need to add to our `index.html.erb` looks like this:

rails7/depot_f/app/views/store/index.html.erb